

NYCU-EE ICLAB – Fall 2025

Lab10 Exercise: Coverage & Assertion

Verification: Role-Playing Game (From Lab09)

Data Preparation

1. Extract test data from TA's directory:
% tar xvf ~iclabTA01/Lab10.tar
2. The extracted LAB directory contains:
Exercise/
3. DO NOT paste the pseudo_DRAM.sv from Lab09 to the Lab10.

Description

You need to write the verification pattern for the RPG from Lab09. You need to complete following things:

1. **PATTERN.sv** (Lab10/Exercise/00_TESTBED/PATTERN.sv)
Generate pattern data.
Send pattern data to RPG.sv and make sure that it will achieve coverage goals.
You also need to **check** the correctness of the output signals of the design.
2. **CHECKER.sv** (Lab10/Exercise/00_TESTBED/CHECKER.sv)
Write your cover groups and assertions here.

Specifications

Coverage:

1. Each case of **Training_Type** should be select at least 200 times.
2. Each case of **Mode** should be select at least 200 times.
3. Create a cross bin for the SPEC1 and SPEC2. Each combination should be selected at least 200 times. (Type_A, Type_B, Type_C, Type_D) x (Easy, Normal, Hard)
4. Create a covergroup including coverpoint inf.D.d_player_no[0] with auto_bin_max = 256, and each bin has to be hit at least 2 times. (sample the value at posedge clk iff inf.player_no_valid is high)
5. Create the transitions bin for the inf.D.act[0] signal from [Login:Check_Inactive] to [Login:Check_Inactive]. Each transition should be hit at least 200 times. (sample the value at posedge clk iff inf.sel_action_valid)
6. Create a covergroup for MP consumed by skill of “use skill” action with auto_bin_max = 32, and each bin have to hit at least one time.

7. Output signal `inf.Warn_Msg` should be “No_Warn”, “Date_Warn”, “Exp_Warn”, “HP_Warn”, “MP_Warn” and “Saturation_Warn”, each at least 20 times. (Sample the value when `inf.out_valid` is high)

Notice:

1. When you send the pattern to the `RPG.sv`, you need to follow the specs from the Lab09. For example, all input valid signals won't overlap with each other. You can write some assertions in your `CHECKER.sv` to check. If you violate the specs and your assertions didn't discover but TA discover during demo, you will fail.
2. After passing the last pattern, your `PATTERN` should finish immediately. (Still remember not to violate any specs.)
3. During demo, TA will also use wrong design (7 cases) to test if your pattern can check the correctness of the output signals of the design. When the answer is wrong, you should stop the program immediately and display “Wrong Answer” on the terminal.
 - “./00_run_cov” for normal design
 - “./00_run_cov FAIL_X” for error answer design, e.g. “./00_run_cov FAIL_1”
 - 7 Error Answer Cases, from `FAIL_1` to `FAIL_7`
4. Under `01_RTL`, you can use bellowing commands to check your coverage result.
 - A. “00_run_cov” for running your design and generate the coverage related files.
 - B. “02_cov_detail” for generating the detail report (`01_RTL/Report/Coverage_Detail.log`) of your coverage result.
 - C. “03_cov_summary” for generating the brief report (`01_RTL/Report/Coverage_Summary.log`) of your coverage result. You should ensure both of CoverGroup Average/Covered to 100% coverage.
- D. “imc &” for starting Cadence IMC (Incisive Metrics Center) in gui mode. (Please refer to appendix)
- E. “imc -batch” for starting Cadence IMC (Incisive Metrics Center) in batch (shell) mode.

name	CoverGroup Average	CoverGroup Covered
Checker	100.00%	100.00% (80/80)

Assertion:

1. All outputs signals (including `RPG.sv`) should be zero after reset.
2. Latency should be less than 1000 cycles for each operation.
3. If action is completed (`complete=1`), `Warn_Msg` should be 3'b0 (No_Warn).
4. Next input valid will be valid 1-4 cycles after previous input valid fall.
5. All input valid signals won't overlap with each other.

6. Out_valid can only be high for **exactly** one cycle.
7. Next operation will be valid 1-4 cycles after out_valid fall.
8. The input date from pattern should adhere to the real calendar. (ex: 2/29, 3/0, 4/31, 13/1 are illegal cases)
9. The AR_VALID signal should not overlap with the AW_VALID signal.

Notice:

1. You can't use PATTERN.sv to check the spec above.
2. Once the spec is violated, you should stop the program immediately and show the assertion message on the terminal. Your assertion warning messages should be "Assertion X is violated", where X is the number of assertions. You can directly copy the messages provided by TA in 00_TESTBED/message.txt . For normal design, please use "01_run"; For testing error design, use "01_run SPEC_X_Y", please refer to the table in grading policy.
3. The definition of cycle and latency is the same as Lab09.

Self Testing Flow

1. ./00_run_cov (For Coverage)

TA's design + Your Checker + Your Pattern (including your dram.dat)

2. ./01_run (For Assertion)

TA's design + Your Checker + TA's Pattern (including your dram.dat)

TA's Demo Flow

1. (TA's DESIGN + TA's CHECKER + **Your PATTERN**):

Test your pattern if it can pass TA's design and checker, and detect the error answer in TA's design (FAIL1~FAIL_7)

2. (TA's DESIGN + TA's PATTERN+ **Your CHECKER**):

Test your checker if it can pass and find every hidden error in TA's design and pattern.
(SPEC_1_1 ~ SPEC_9_1)

3. (TA's DESIGN + **Your CHECKER** + **Your PATTERN (including your dram.dat)**):

Test your pattern and checker if their coverage rate can reach 100%, and measure their simulation time of coverage.

Note

3. Grading Policy

- **Coverage: 50%**
- 10%: Pass each item of the command ". /00_run_cov" in the table below.
- 30%: 100% Coverage (requires passing the previous item).

- 10%: Simulation time of coverage (You need to pass all specs in coverage and assertion and will get the simulation time score.).
- **Assertion: 50%**
- Please refer to the table for each item's (./01_run) point (Total 10 items).

```

-----
                  Congratulations!
                You have passed all patterns!
-----
Simulation complete via $finish(1) at time 3700 NS + 0
./PATTERN.v:242    $finish;
ncsim> exit

```

	Command	Print From	You should Print	Points
./00_run_cov	(None)	PATTERN.sv	Congratulations	2%
	FAIL_1~FAIL_7	PATTERN.sv	Wrong Answer	8%
./01_run	(None)	PATTERN.sv	Congratulations	6%
	SPEC_1_1 ~ SPEC_1_8	CHECKER.sv	Assertion 1 is violated	5%
	SPEC_2_1 ~ SPEC_2_5	CHECKER.sv	Assertion 2 is violated	5%
	SPEC_3_1	CHECKER.sv	Assertion 3 is violated	5%
	SPEC_4_1 ~ SPEC_4_6	CHECKER.sv	Assertion 4 is violated	5%
	SPEC_5_1 ~ SPEC_5_6	CHECKER.sv	Assertion 5 is violated	5%
	SPEC_6_1	CHECKER.sv	Assertion 6 is violated	4%
	SPEC_7_1	CHECKER.sv	Assertion 7 is violated	4%
	SPEC_8_1 ~ SPEC_8_6	CHECKER.sv	Assertion 8 is violated	6%
	SPEC_9_1	CHECKER.sv	Assertion 9 is violated	5%

(The info that need to print can be copied from 00_TESTBED/message.txt)

The second demo will be 30% off.

4. 1st demo: 2025/11/24 (MON) 12:00; 2nd demo: 2025/11/26 (WED) 12:00

5. Please submit the following files by 09_submit (Will be automatically packaged by 00_tar):

- PATTERN.sv
- CHECKER.sv
- dram.dat

Remember using dram.dat when you read your data in pattern. Or you will be failed at demo.

You can use any software language (e.g. Python, C/Cpp) to generate.

- Usertype.sv

6. Since the purpose of this Lab is to use SystemVerilog to do verification. You should generate pattern in the PATTERN.sv directly instead of using read file method.

7. Don't use any wire/reg/submodule/parameter name called *error*, *latch* or *fail* otherwise you will fail the lab. Note: * means any char in front of or behind the word. e.g: error_note is forbidden.

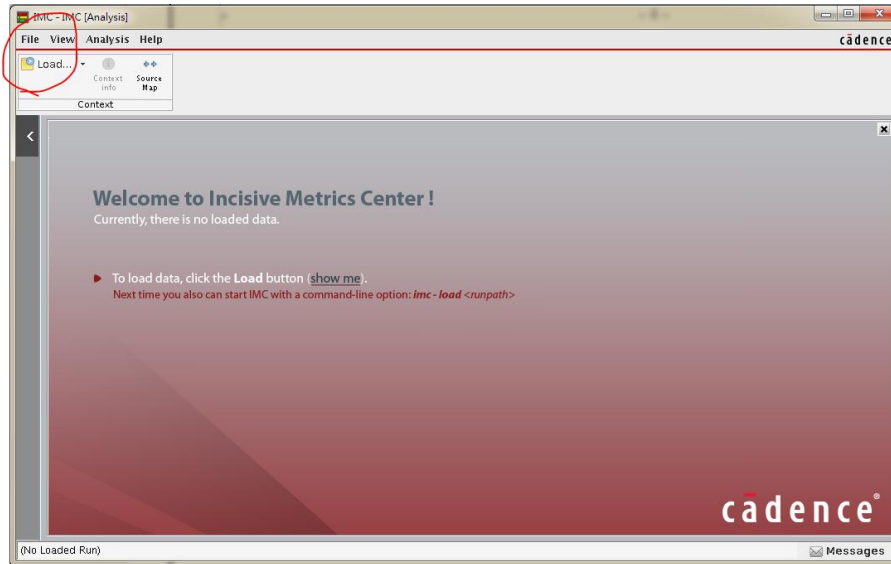
Using GUI Mode of Cadence IMC (Incisive Metrics Center)

1. % ./00_run_cov

```
4 18:03 TESTBED.SV -> ./00_TESTBED/TESTBED.SV
8 18:30 cov_work
8 18:27 imc.log
8 18:30 icrun.log
```

2. % imc &

3. Load the coverage database (default path: /01_RTL/cov_work/scope/test)



Panel

List of Analytic Page

Name	Overall Average Grade	Overall Covered	Assertion Status Grade
Verification Metrics	95.83%	40 / 42 (95.24%)	100%
Types	91.67%	38 / 40 (95%)	100%
Unit	n/a	0 / 0 (n/a)	n/a
TESTBED	83.33%	36 / 38 (94.74%)	n/a
SCORE	n/a	0 / 0 (n/a)	n/a
PATTERN	n/a	0 / 0 (n/a)	n/a
Checker	100%	2 / 2 (100%)	100%
Instances	100%	2 / 2 (100%)	100%
Unit	n/a	0 / 0 (n/a)	n/a
TESTBED	100%	2 / 2 (100%)	100%

Details of Types

Name	Overall Average Grade	Overall Covered
Overall	91.67%	38 / 40 (95%)
Code	n/a	0 / 0 (n/a)
Block	n/a	0 / 0 (n/a)
Expression	n/a	0 / 0 (n/a)
Toggle	n/a	0 / 0 (n/a)
FSM	n/a	0 / 0 (n/a)
Functional	91.67%	38 / 40 (95%)
Assertion	100%	2 / 2 (100%)
CoverGroup	83.33%	36 / 38 (94.74%)

Detail:
Contribution of coverage grade
Attributes
Source code

4. Covergroup analysis

The screenshot shows the Cadence IMC - IMC [Analysis - Summary] window. The main pane displays the Verification Hierarchy with a tree view on the left and a table of metrics on the right. The tree view includes categories like Verification Metrics, Types, Instances, and Checker. The table shows the Overall Average Grade, Overall Covered, and Assertion Status Grade for each category. The Checker window on the right shows the Relative Elements table, which lists the elements and their coverage status.

Name	Overall Average Grade	Overall Covered
Verification Metrics	100%	216 / 216 (100%)
Types	100%	108 / 108 (100%)
Instances	100%	108 / 108 (100%)
Checker	100%	108 / 108 (100%)
Block Analysis	100%	108 / 108 (100%)
Expression Analysis	100%	108 / 108 (100%)
Toggle Analysis	100%	108 / 108 (100%)
FSM Analysis	100%	108 / 108 (100%)
Cover Group Analysis	100%	108 / 108 (100%)
Assertion Analysis	100%	108 / 108 (100%)
Lookup Type	100%	108 / 108 (100%)
Report On Selected Entry	100%	108 / 108 (100%)
Exclude	100%	108 / 108 (100%)
Exclude Local Aspects only	100%	108 / 108 (100%)
Un-Exclude	100%	108 / 108 (100%)
Approve Rules	100%	108 / 108 (100%)
Collapse Sub-Tree	100%	108 / 108 (100%)
Unfilter Table	100%	108 / 108 (100%)
Copy Cell	100%	108 / 108 (100%)
Copy Row	100%	108 / 108 (100%)

5. Detail of items inside covergroup

The screenshot shows the Cadence IMC - IMC [Analysis - Functional] window. The main pane displays the CoverGroup Local Grade and the BINS OF: latency_check table. The table shows the Overall Average Grade, Overall Covered, and Score for each bin. The table is annotated with red circles and arrows indicating the steps to view the detail of items inside a covergroup.

3. Detail information of your bins are shown here

1. Choose the covergroup you want to see

2. Click the item

Every coverage spec should be 100%

Name	Overall Average Grade	Overall Covered	Score
auto(1)	100%	1 / 1 (100%)	4
auto(4-7)	100%	1 / 1 (100%)	253
auto(8-11)	100%	1 / 1 (100%)	254
auto(12-15)	100%	1 / 1 (100%)	256
auto(16-19)	100%	1 / 1 (100%)	3
auto(20-23)	100%	1 / 1 (100%)	254
auto(24-27)	100%	1 / 1 (100%)	504
auto(28-31)	100%	1 / 1 (100%)	9
auto(32-35)	100%	1 / 1 (100%)	3
auto(36-39)	100%	1 / 1 (100%)	4
auto(40-43)	100%	1 / 1 (100%)	251
auto(44-47)	100%	1 / 1 (100%)	254
auto(48-51)	100%	1 / 1 (100%)	4
auto(52-55)	100%	1 / 1 (100%)	253
auto(56-59)	100%	1 / 1 (100%)	3
auto(60-63)	100%	1 / 1 (100%)	2
auto(64-67)	100%	1 / 1 (100%)	257
auto(68-71)	100%	1 / 1 (100%)	252
auto(72-75)	100%	1 / 1 (100%)	4
auto(76-79)	100%	1 / 1 (100%)	252
auto(80-83)	100%	1 / 1 (100%)	509
auto(84-87)	100%	1 / 1 (100%)	2
auto(88-91)	100%	1 / 1 (100%)	3
auto(92-95)	100%	1 / 1 (100%)	255
auto(96-99)	100%	1 / 1 (100%)	253
auto(100-103)	100%	1 / 1 (100%)	255
auto(104-107)	100%	1 / 1 (100%)	2

6. Check your source code

The screenshot shows the Cadence JMC [Analysis - Functional] interface. The top menu bar includes File, View, Analysis, and Help. The main window displays coverage analysis results for the 'prop_check' testbench.

Cover Groups (83.33%)

Name	Overall Average Grade	Overall Covered
cov	83.33%	36 / 38 (94.74%)

Items of: cov

Name	Overall Average Grade	Overall Covered
latency_check	100%	32 / 32 (100%)
prop_check	66.67%	4 / 6 (66.67%)

BINS OF: prop_check

Name	Overall Average Grade	Overall Covered	Score
s0	0%	0 / 1 (0%)	0
s1	100%	1 / 1 (100%)	5780
s2	100%	1 / 1 (100%)	55
s3	100%	1 / 1 (100%)	30
s4	100%	1 / 1 (100%)	1255
s5	0%	0 / 1 (0%)	0

Details of: prop_check

Attributes: **Source**

TESTBED by

```

30 latency_check: coverpoint pf_latency(
31   option auto_bin_max = 32;
40 )
41
42 prop_check: coverpoint pf_prop(
43   bins s0 = {0..10};
44   bins s1 = {11..20};
45   bins s2 = {21..30};
46   bins s3 = {31..40};
47 )
  
```

Loaded Run: /misc/RAND2/COURSE/iclab/iclabna03/lab2_test/01_RTL/cov_work/scope/test

